

THE THIRD SPACE

Functional Requirements Document

Combined Product Requirements + Business Requirements | Feature Brief

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PART A: BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

This section establishes the business case for The Third Space — why this product is being built, who it serves, what success looks like, and the return on investment rationale.

A1. Purpose — Why This Product Exists

The Third Space is being built to solve a real, documented, and growing public health problem: urban loneliness. New York City — the most densely populated city in America — is paradoxically one of the loneliest places in the country. Despite being surrounded by millions of people, NYC residents in their 20s and 30s consistently report serious social isolation, difficulty making friends as adults, and a lack of accessible, safe, and genuine ways to meet like-minded people in person.

Every existing solution fails in a specific and meaningful way:

- Eventbrite and Posh are pure ticketing platforms — transactional and anonymous with zero social layer
- Meetup is outdated and clinical — limited profiles, weak connection features, no pre- or post-event social engagement
- Bumble BFF is under-maintained and too closely associated with its dating roots — users don't trust the environment for real friendship
- Timeleft and 222 built interesting concepts around stranger dinners but are fundamentally broken in execution — more than half of attendees don't show up, there are no profiles before or after, and there is no way to continue the connection once the event ends
- Facebook Events and Instagram are passive discovery tools — not friendship-building platforms

- Numerous startup attempts have tried and failed because they replicated dating mechanics, ignored profile quality, or prioritized quantity of events over quality of connection

The gap is clear and unaddressed: there is no app that combines a safe, profile-first environment with in-person, interest-based community building that genuinely works for every kind of person seeking real connection.

The Business Case in One Sentence

The Third Space monetizes the loneliness epidemic by connecting people through real experiences at real venues — generating recurring revenue from both the users who need community and the small businesses that need customers.

A2. Business Goals

- Launch a functional MVP simultaneously in Brooklyn and Manhattan
- Onboard a minimum of 20 venue partners across both boroughs in Year 1
- Reach 1,000 active users within 6 months of launch
- Generate initial revenue through venue partner listing fees from Day 1 — before premium user features activate
- Win or place in the PowerUP 2026 Business Plan Competition (\$20,000 prize toward development and launch)
- File LLC and trademark for The Third Space before app development begins
- Expand to all five NYC boroughs within 24 months of initial launch
- Build brand presence on TikTok and Instagram pre-launch to create demand before the app is available

A3. Stakeholder Needs

Stakeholder	What They Need	How The Third Space Delivers
App Users (18-40, NYC)	A safe, genuine way to find friends and community based on shared interests — explicitly not dating	ID-verified profiles required before any access, interest-based event feed, pre-event attendee messaging, per-event group chats, post-event reconnecting via attendee list
Brooklyn & Manhattan Small Businesses	Consistent new foot traffic, paying customers, and community visibility they can't get from Instagram alone	Events hosted at their venue drive registered, engaged attendees through the door; monthly partner listing provides ongoing exposure

Founder — Samantha Aleman	A legally protected, scalable, revenue-generating business that solves a real problem and builds lasting community in NYC	Multi-stream revenue model, LLC and trademark protection, developer-ready documentation, clear MVP scope
Investors & Competition Judges	Proof of market demand, a defensible competitive position, a clear revenue model, and a scalable concept	Documented loneliness statistics, competitor gap analysis, real user stories, financial projections, and a working Figma prototype

A4. Use Cases & User Stories

These stories demonstrate the real-world value The Third Space delivers to its users and venue partners. Each story represents a distinct user segment the platform is designed to serve.

Story 1 — Maya, 27: The New Transplant

Maya just moved to Brooklyn from Miami for work. She knows no one. She downloads The Third Space, creates her full verified profile with tags like 'painting', 'yoga', and 'brunch'. She finds a ceramics class at a Williamsburg studio. Before she even goes, she can see 8 other women with similar profiles are registered. She messages two of them. They arrive already excited to meet each other. She leaves with three new contacts and a group chat still going a week later. This is her first real NYC friendship — made through an app that required her to show up as a real person first.

Story 2 — Marcus, 31: The Remote Worker

Marcus works from home in Crown Heights. His social circle has quietly shrunk to almost nothing. He signs up, adds tags like 'basketball', 'film', and 'going out'. He finds a pickup basketball game at a local court and a rooftop bar night the same weekend. He joins both group chats, introduces himself, and arrives at each event already knowing names. It's the most social weekend he's had in two years — and he found it without awkwardly approaching strangers cold.

Story 3 — Jasmine, 25: LGBTQ+ Community Building

Jasmine wants to find her people. She filters friend suggestions by LGBTQ+ community and finds a drag brunch at a Park Slope bar. She sees 15 attendees, recognizes someone from a mutual Instagram follow, and messages them through the app before the event. They arrive together. She ends the night with five new follows and two group chats active. She found a community she never would have found on any existing platform.

Story 4 — Devon, 29: Building a Nightlife Crew

Devon is new to the city and tired of going out alone. He finds a nightlife event at a trendy Lower East Side bar on The Third Space. He can see who else is going, spots a few guys with similar

taste, messages them: 'Yo I'm going to this too, let's link up.' They meet at the door. By the end of the night he has a new crew. This is the straight male social use case that no existing app has ever solved well.

Story 5 — Sofia, 32: The Creative Who Wants to Host

Sofia is a stylist who wants to build a community of creatives around her. She upgrades to premium membership and creates a 'Style Swap & Networking' event at a Bushwick studio she loves. Eight people sign up. Three venue partners reach out asking her to host future events. Her personal brand grows alongside her social circle — and The Third Space earns a hosting fee.

Story 6 — The Sewing Studio, Bushwick: Venue Partner

A small sewing studio lists two free trial events — 'Make Your Own Bikini Top' workshops. Both fill to 12 spots within 48 hours. Attendees pay the studio directly for materials. Three attendees messaged each other before the event and arrived as a mini group. The studio converts to a \$100/month paid partner listing within 60 days and is fully booked every week within 90. This is the venue revenue story — recurring income from customers they never could have found on Instagram alone.

A5. Success Metrics

Metric	6-Month Target	12-Month Target
Active users — Brooklyn & Manhattan	1,000	5,000
Venue partners onboarded	10	20+
Events hosted per month	20	50+
Monthly recurring revenue	\$500–\$1,500	\$2,000–\$5,000
App Store rating	4.0+	4.5+
User retention — return within 30 days	40%	60%
Average events attended per active user	2	4+

A6. ROI Rationale

Why The Third Space will generate a return on investment:

- **LOW COST ACQUISITION:** Primary growth channels are organic — TikTok and Instagram Reels, founder-led content showing how to use the app, word of mouth at

events, in-person promotion at parks and community spaces, and neighborhood posters. No paid advertising required in Year 1.

- **RECURRING VENUE REVENUE FROM DAY 1:** Venue partners pay monthly listing fees regardless of how many tickets are sold. With 10 partners at an average of \$75/month that is \$750/month in recurring revenue before a single user pays anything.
- **NETWORK EFFECTS:** Every new user makes the platform more valuable to every other user. More users = more event registrations = more venue revenue = more partners want to join.
- **MULTIPLE REVENUE STREAMS:** Venue listing fees + per-event ticket splits + premium user subscriptions + future brand sponsorships means no single point of revenue failure.
- **MASSIVE UNDERSERVED MARKET:** More than 50% of NYC residents report loneliness. The 18-40 demographic in Brooklyn and Manhattan alone represents over 1 million potential users. Even 0.5% penetration in Year 1 = 5,000 users.
- **TIMING:** Post-pandemic social hunger, Gen Z and Millennial burnout on dating apps, remote work isolation, and the U.S. Surgeon General's declaration of a loneliness epidemic have created a perfect cultural moment. The market is primed.
- **SCALABLE MODEL:** The platform model — venue partners + user base + events — replicates to any urban market. Brooklyn and Manhattan prove the concept, then the Bronx, Queens, and Staten Island, then other cities.

PART B: FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

This section defines exactly what the app must do — every feature, every screen, every button, every interaction. This document is the developer's source of truth. Nothing gets built that is not in this document. Nothing in this document gets skipped without founder approval.

B1. User Onboarding & Profile Creation

ABSOLUTE RULE — NON-NEGOTIABLE

A user CANNOT view the event feed, browse attendees, register for any event, send any message, or access any feature of the app until their profile is 100% complete with verified photo, required bio, and minimum interest tags selected. This is the single most important differentiator from every competing platform. The profile IS the product.

B1.1 Account Creation

Registration options — user may choose any of the following:

- Email and password
- Apple ID (Sign in with Apple)
- Google account
- Instagram login

Regardless of login method chosen — ID verification is ALWAYS required. Instagram login does not bypass verification.

Age confirmation flow:

- User must confirm they are 18 or older before proceeding
- Date of birth entry required — system calculates age
- If under 18: access denied, appropriate message displayed
- 21+ age gating is applied per individual event at registration — not at account level

B1.2 ID Verification

ID verification is required for all users before profile is considered complete:

- User submits a live selfie photo during profile creation
- System cross-references selfie with government-issued ID photo
- Suggested integration options: Stripe Identity (most cost-effective), Jumio, or Onfido — final selection TBD based on cost
- Verified users receive a subtle verification badge on their profile
- If verification fails: user is prompted to retry or contact support
- If profile photo is later changed: re-verification required
- Unverified accounts have ZERO app access — not even read-only browsing

B1.3 Required Profile Fields — Cannot Skip, Cannot Bypass

- **PROFILE PHOTO:** Must match ID-verified selfie. Single primary photo required. Up to 5 additional 'vibe photos' allowed. Photos must show personality — moderator review for inappropriate content.
- **BIO:** Minimum 20 characters, maximum 300. Required — cannot be left blank. App displays writing prompts inside the text field to guide users: 'What neighborhood are you in?', 'What are you looking to do on this app?', 'What activities or hobbies are you into?', 'Who are you hoping to meet?', 'Where are you originally from?', 'Anything you'd want a potential new friend to know about you?'
- **INTEREST TAGS:** Minimum 3 tags required from a categorized preset list. User cannot proceed without selecting at least 3. Full tag list covered in B1.4.
- **BOROUGH & NEIGHBORHOOD:** User selects their borough (Brooklyn, Manhattan, Queens, Bronx, Staten Island) and general neighborhood from a dropdown list.
- **WHO I WANT TO MEET:** User selects from — Women, Men, LGBTQ+ Community, Everyone / Mixed. Used for friend suggestion filtering. Not publicly displayed.
- **SEXUAL ORIENTATION:** Optional field. Used algorithmically for suggestion filtering only. Never displayed publicly without user's explicit choice.

Optional profile fields (encouraged but not required):

- Favorite music genres — displayed on profile, used for matching on nightlife and dance events
- Where you are originally from

B1.4 Interest Tag Categories

Category	Example Tags
Creative Arts	Painting, Drawing, Sewing, Ceramics, Sculpting, Fashion Design, Styling, Photography, Collage, Jewelry Making
Fitness & Movement	Yoga, Pilates, Dance, Trapeze, Aerial Arts, Gymnastics, Swimming, Hiking, Running, Martial Arts, Basketball, Cycling
Food & Drink	Cooking Classes, Baking, Wine Tasting, Coffee, Brunch, Food Tours
Music	Live Music, DJing, Open Mic, Playing Instruments, Concerts, Record Collecting
Social & Games	Book Club, Board Games, Trivia, Card Games, Chess, Puzzles
Nightlife	Bar Nights, Club Events, Rooftop Parties, Speakeasies (21+ events)
Learning & Growth	Language Exchange, Finance, Tech, Entrepreneurship, History, Self-Development
Outdoor & Active	Parks, Gardening, Kayaking, Cycling, Picnics, Beach Days, Nature Walks
Wellness	Meditation, Sound Baths, Journaling, Mental Health, Breathwork
Creative Performance	Theater, Improv, Spoken Word, Poetry, Drag, Karaoke

B1.5 Profile Completion Flow & Exit Prompts

- A progress bar is displayed at the top of the screen throughout the entire profile creation flow
- If user taps the back button or attempts to exit the app during profile creation: prompt displays — 'Your profile isn't complete yet. You won't be able to browse events or connect with anyone until you finish. Continue setting up?'
- User can save progress and return to the app later — but sees a locked screen with the prompt to complete their profile until it is 100% done
- No read-only browsing is permitted. Zero. The event feed is completely hidden until profile is complete.

B2. Main Event Feed

B2.1 Feed Layout & Navigation

- Scrollable vertical feed is the primary home screen — first thing user sees after completing profile

- Category filter tabs pinned at the top of the feed: All | Creative Arts | Fitness | Social | Nightlife | Food & Drink | Music | Outdoors | Learning | Wellness
- Tapping a category tab instantly filters the feed to that category only
- Search bar at top of feed — searches event names, venues, and neighborhoods
- Filter button opens secondary filter panel: by date range, neighborhood, free/paid only, age requirement (18+ or 21+)
- 'Starting Soon' badge displayed on any event beginning within 24 hours
- Feed updates in real time — new events appear without requiring manual refresh

B2.2 Event Card — What Each Card Shows

- Event title
- Category tag (color-coded by category)
- Venue name and neighborhood
- Date and time
- Cost — 'Free' or dollar amount
- Number of people currently registered
- Attendee preview photos — BLURRED before registration. 3-4 circular blurred profile photo thumbnails visible to create curiosity. Text reads: 'See who's going →' with a lock icon.
- Age requirement badge if applicable: '21+' displayed clearly

B2.3 Attendee Preview — Blurred / Unblurred Logic

- BEFORE registering: all attendee photos on the event card and event detail page are BLURRED. User can see the number of attendees and blurred silhouettes but cannot identify anyone.
- The blurred preview is intentional — it creates curiosity and incentivizes sign-up
- AFTER registering: the full attendee list unlocks immediately. All photos become clear.
- The unblurred attendee list is organized into columns: Women | Men | Other
- Each attendee entry shows: profile photo, display name, bio snippet, interest tags, who they are looking to meet
- App displays AI-generated suggestions: 'Based on your interests and who you want to meet, you might want to say hi to: [Name], [Name], [Name]'

B3. Event Detail Page & Registration

B3.1 Event Detail Page Content

- Full event title and description — what to expect, what to bring, dress code if applicable
- Venue name, full address, and embedded Google Maps preview (tapping opens Google Maps app)

- Host information — venue partner profile with name, photo, and brief description
- Date, start time, estimated end time, and duration
- Capacity — total spots available
- Spots remaining — updates in real time (e.g. '4 spots left!')
- Cost — free or ticket price clearly displayed
- Age requirement — 18+ or 21+ badge displayed prominently
- Category tags
- Attendee preview (blurred before registration, full list after)
- Register button — large, prominent, primary CTA
- Bookmark/Save button — saves event to user's saved list
- Share button — shares event link to external apps
- Report event button — for inappropriate or fraudulent listings

B3.2 Registration Flow — Step by Step

- User taps 'Register' button on event detail page
- If event is FREE: confirmation screen appears — 'You're in! [Event Name] on [Date]' → attendee list and group chat unlock immediately
- If event is PAID: payment screen appears
- Payment screen shows: event name, date, cost breakdown, payment method options
- Payment options: Apple Pay (default if available), Google Pay, credit/debit card via Stripe, PayPal
- User confirms payment → success screen → attendee list and group chat options unlock
- If 21+ event: age verification confirmation prompt appears before payment — user must confirm they are 21 or older
- Confirmation push notification sent immediately after registration
- Event added to user's 'My Events' section in their profile
- Cancel Registration option: available up to [TBD] hours before event — refund policy to be defined

B3.3 Post-Registration — What Unlocks

- Full unblurred attendee list with columns and friend suggestions
- Option to join the general event group chat
- Option to create a smaller private group chat with specific attendees
- Ability to send private message requests to any registered attendee
- Access to event announcements from the venue host
- Attendee list remains accessible AFTER the event ends — indefinitely or for a set period TBD
- POST-EVENT USE CASE: If you met someone at the event but did not get their contact info — open the event, go to the attendee list, find them, and send a message request. No moment is lost.

B3.4 Push Notification Schedule — Per Event

- Immediately upon registration: 'You're registered for [Event Name] on [Date]!'
- 10 hours before event: '[Event Name] is tomorrow! Check who's going and say hi 🙌'
- 24 hours before event: '[Event Name] is in 24 hours — are you ready?'
- 1 hour before event: '[Event Name] starts in 1 hour — see you there!'
- 'Starting Now' notification: '[Event Name] is starting now! Head over to [Venue]'
- All notifications use The Third Space's unique custom notification sound — to be produced during development
- User can manage notification preferences in settings

B4. Group Chat System

Important — Group Chats Are Not Auto-Forced

Users are not automatically dumped into a single mass group chat. The system provides options and suggestions — giving users agency over who they communicate with. This is intentional.

- GENERAL EVENT CHAT: A general group chat exists for every event. It is optional — users choose to join or not after registering. All registered attendees can join.
- SUGGESTED SUBGROUP CHATS: The app auto-generates suggested smaller group chats based on compatibility matching within the registered attendee list. Examples: 'Women going to this event who want to meet other women', 'People going to this event who are into fitness', 'LGBTQ+ attendees at this event'. User taps to join if interested.
- USER-CREATED CHATS: Any registered attendee can create their own group chat and invite specific other attendees they want to connect with. This is the primary intended use case — building a small pre-event crew.
- CHAT DURATION: All event group chats remain active for 7 days after the event ends, then archive.
- MODERATION: Users can report messages. Moderators review reported content. Community guidelines enforced.
- CHAT FEATURES: Text messages, photos, GIFs, voice notes — same convenience as iMessage.

B5. Private Messaging & Social Features

B5.1 Private Messaging

- Any user can send a private message to any other user
- REQUESTS FOLDER: Messages from users you do not follow land in a 'Requests' folder — NEVER the main inbox. User must actively choose to check requests.

- MAIN INBOX: Only messages from users you follow or have accepted a request from appear here
- User receives a push notification when a new message request arrives — using fun, personality-driven copy:
 - 'Someone thinks you two would vibe!'
 - 'Potential new friend alert — check your requests!'
 - 'You share interests with someone who wants to connect!'
 - 'A new connection request is waiting for you!'
 - 'Someone noticed you — worth a look?'
- User can ACCEPT the request — conversation moves to main inbox
- User can IGNORE / DECLINE the request — sender is not notified
- Messaging supports: text, photos, videos, voice notes, GIFs (iMessage-level convenience)
- PRIMARY PRE-EVENT USE CASE: User registers for an event, browses the attendee list, sees someone with similar interests, sends a message request — 'Hey I saw we're both going to this! I'm into [X] too, want to meet up at the door?'
- PRIMARY POST-EVENT USE CASE: User met someone at an event but forgot to get their contact. They open the event attendee list, find the person, and send a message request.

B5.2 Follow System

- One-directional follow system — like Instagram. You can follow someone without them following you back.
- Following someone moves their messages to your main inbox
- Users can follow others from: their profile page, the attendee list, suggested friends
- FOLLOWER COUNT VISIBILITY: Follower counts are visible ONLY to the account owner in their private profile settings. They are NEVER shown publicly to other users. This removes social climbing dynamics while still giving users personal satisfaction for building connections.
- What IS shown publicly: Points earned, badge level, number of events attended. These are the social proof signals — not follower counts.

B5.3 Friend Suggestions

The app surfaces friend suggestions throughout the experience — on the home screen, within event attendee lists, and in a dedicated 'People You Might Like' section. Suggestions are generated based on:

- Shared interest tags
- Same events registered for or attended
- Same borough or neighborhood
- Compatibility on 'who they want to meet' — e.g. a woman looking to meet women will be suggested to other women looking to meet women
- Mutual connections

- Similar music genre preferences (if provided)

Community-based filtering options in the suggestions view:

- Women looking to meet women
- Men looking to meet men
- LGBTQ+ community
- Everyone / mixed

B6. User Profile — Public View

What other users see when they view someone's profile:

- ID-verified badge
- Display name
- Primary profile photo + additional vibe photos (up to 5)
- Bio
- Interest tags
- Borough / neighborhood
- Who they are looking to meet
- Favorite music genres (if provided)
- Events attended count — shows community involvement
- Points total and current badge level — this is the visible social proof, not follower count
- FOLLOWER COUNT: NOT shown publicly
- Message Request button
- Follow button
- Report / Block button

B7. Points, Badges & Rewards System

The Third Space replaces follower count as the primary social signal with a points and badge system that rewards genuine community participation — proving you show up, not just that you scroll.

B7.1 How Points Are Earned

- Completing your profile 100%
- Attending an event (verified via geolocation check-in at venue)
- Registering for an event
- Sending a message request to a new attendee before an event
- Joining or creating a group chat for an event

- Accepting a message request from a new connection
- Referring a friend who creates a complete profile and attends their first event
- Hosting your own community event (premium members only — highest point reward)
- Bonus points: being proactive before events — the more genuine outreach, the more points

B7.2 What Points Unlock

- Free entry to select events — points can be redeemed instead of paying
- Priority RSVP access for high-demand events before they fill up
- Special profile badge upgrades and visual effects
- Early access to new app features
- Premium feature unlocks (hosting, advanced filters)

B7.3 Badge Milestones

- First Event Attended
- 5 Events Attended
- 10 Events Attended
- 25 Events Attended
- First Friend Made (mutual follow after an event)
- First Group Chat Created
- Connector Badge (messed 10+ people across events)
- Host Badge (hosted first premium event)
- Community Pillar (attended events + referred friends + hosted events)

B7.4 Anti-Gaming Measures

- Event attendance requires geolocation check-in at the venue address — cannot be faked remotely
- Message request points only awarded when messages are genuine (minimum character count, activity threshold)
- System flags accounts with suspicious point patterns for admin review
- Repeated gaming attempts result in point resets and potential account warning

B8. Venue Partner Portal

Venue partners are the small businesses and spaces that host events. They have a separate login, dashboard, and experience from regular users.

- VENUE PROFILE: Business name, logo, address, neighborhood, description of space, photos of venue, website and social links, partner tier badge
- CREATE EVENT: Venue fills in event title, description, category, date/time, capacity, cost, age requirement, any materials or dress code
- EDIT / CANCEL EVENT: Available until [TBD] hours before the event
- VIEW ATTENDEE LIST: Venue can see who is registered — name and confirmation only, not full profile details
- SEND ANNOUNCEMENTS: Venue can send a push notification and in-app message to all registered attendees (e.g. 'Bring your own scissors!', 'Event moved to back room')
- EVENT ANALYTICS: Total registrations, attendance rate post-event, engagement metrics
- BILLING: Manage payment method and subscription tier
- FREE TRIAL: First 2 events listed completely free — zero commitment, zero cost
- CONVERSION: After 2 free events, venue is prompted to convert to paid monthly listing (\$50-\$150/month depending on tier)

B9. Safety & Moderation

- ALL profiles are ID-verified — zero anonymous access at any time
- Block any user — blocked users cannot see your profile, message you, or appear in your suggestions
- Report any user, venue, event, or message — goes to admin dashboard for review
- Admin dashboard: moderators review reports, can warn users, temporarily suspend, or permanently ban
- Community guidelines displayed during onboarding and accessible at all times in settings — users must agree before account creation
- Violations: first offense = warning, second = temporary suspension, third = permanent ban
- Age-gating: 21+ events require age confirmation at registration — users who provided false age during onboarding are subject to ban
- Message request system prevents any unwanted contact from reaching main inbox
- Photo moderation: profile photos reviewed against ID verification and checked for inappropriate content
- Future Phase 2: SOS / safety check-in feature for solo attendees

B10. Out of Scope — Phase 1 MVP

Why This Section Exists

This section explicitly documents what will NOT be built in the MVP. Its purpose is to prevent scope creep — the tendency for a build to expand beyond budget and timeline when features get added without boundaries. Everything listed here is intentionally deferred to Phase 2 or later.

- Dating or romantic matching — NEVER in scope. Not Phase 2, not Phase 3. Never.
- Android app — iOS first. Android is Phase 2.
- Web or desktop version — mobile app only for MVP
- Rewards/points system activation — infrastructure built in MVP, feature turned on in Phase 2
- Premium profile tier activation — infrastructure built in MVP, payments activated in Phase 2
- User-created public events for non-premium members — Phase 2
- SOS / safety check-in feature — Phase 2
- Expansion beyond Brooklyn and Manhattan — Phase 2
- Brand sponsorship ad integration — Phase 2
- AI-powered smart moderation — Phase 2 (human moderation in MVP)

Confirmed IN SCOPE for MVP despite initially being considered Phase 2:

- Photo, video, voice note, and GIF support in messaging — included in MVP per founder direction
- Points and badge infrastructure — built in MVP, activated fully in Phase 2

B11. Open Questions

The following decisions remain open and require further input from advisors, developers, and/or legal counsel before finalization:

- ID verification provider: Stripe Identity vs. Jumio vs. Onfido — cost comparison needed
- iOS only MVP or simultaneous iOS + Android?
- No-code (Bubble/Glide) vs. custom development — quality vs. cost tradeoff for this feature set?
- Realistic development cost range for the full MVP feature set above
- Optimal Premium Profile pricing — \$7.99, \$9.99, or \$12.99/month?
- Free venue trial: 2 free events or 3 before converting to paid?
- Exact revenue split % between The Third Space and venue on paid event tickets
- Cancellation and refund policy — how many hours before event?
- PCI compliance structure for user payment data storage
- Group chat moderation at scale — human review vs. AI flagging vs. community reporting only
- Which Brooklyn and Manhattan neighborhoods to target first for venue outreach
- Custom notification sound — needs to be designed and produced during development
- Follower count visibility — final decision: only visible to owner (current plan) or fully hidden even from owner?

B12. Technical Overview

- Platform: iOS mobile app — primary MVP. Android is Phase 2.
- Design: Figma prototype complete — developer receives full access after NDA is signed
- Suggested backend: Firebase (real-time database, authentication, push notifications) or AWS
- Payment processing: Stripe (primary), PayPal (secondary)
- Login methods: Email, Apple ID, Google, Instagram — ID verification required for all
- ID verification integration: Stripe Identity, Jumio, or Onfido (TBD)
- Maps: Google Maps API
- Real-time messaging infrastructure: Firebase Realtime Database or Twilio
- Media in messages: photos, videos, voice notes, GIFs (iMessage parity)
- Push notifications: Firebase Cloud Messaging (FCM)
- PCI compliance required for all payment data — Stripe handles card data vault
- Geolocation: used for event check-in verification and neighborhood-based filtering
- Scalable architecture required — must handle NYC-level concurrent users at launch
- ALL developer engagements require signed NDA before receiving Figma access or this document